LAL BAHADUR SHASTRI TO INDIRA GANDHI— THE CONSOLIDATION PHASE

Lal Bahadur Shastri (1965–1966)

After the death of Jawaharlal Nehru, Lal Bahadur Shastri became the Prime Minister of India for a very brief period. He gave currency to the slogan *Jai Jawan, Jai Kisan* on the wake of the first real Indo–Pak War, which took place in September 1965. Under his leadership India gave a befitting reply to Pakistan between Indian and Pakistan and the Indian army reached almost the outskirts of Lahore. Ultimately, ceasefire was declared under the auspices of the United Nations Security Council. The Soviet Union took the initiative to bring about peace negotiations between India and Pakistan and Shastri met Field Marshall Ayub Khan, President of Pakistan, in Tashkent (now the capital of Uzbekistan) and the Tashkent Declaration was signed on 10 January 1966. This provided for the following:

1. Restoration of normal and peaceful relations between India and Pakistan.
2. Reaffirmation of their obligations under UN charter to settle their disputes through peaceful means.
3. Agreement to base their relations on the principle of non-interference in the internal affairs of each other.
4. Meetings at the highest level as also at other levels to discuss matters of direct concern to both.

Lal Bahadur Shastri also took initiative to improve India's relationship with her other neighbours such as Nepal, Myanmar and Sri Lanka. With Sri Lanka, Shastri signed an Agreement with Sirimavo Bandaranaike in October 1964. Under this agreement, out of the 775,000 Indian Tamil settlers in Sri Lanka, 300,000 were to be granted Sri Lankan citizenship and 325,000 were to be repatriated to India within a period of 15 years. The status of the future of the remaining 150,000 Tamils was to be settled later.

He also tried to build good relations with both the superpowers and succeeded in procuring military and economic assistance from them. Only the 1965 War between India and Pakistan provided the occasion for Washington and London to suspend the military aid and